

THE MELGHAT TIGER RESERVE



WILDFILE NAGPUR

Murud Janjira, approximately 165 kilometres from Mumbai, boasts a well-preserved marine fort with 19 rounded bastions and historic cannons. This self-sufficient fortress once accommodated palaces, officers' quarters, places of worship, and freshwater wells. Vijaydurg Fort, around 48 kilometres south of Ratnagiri, is renowned as one of the west coast's strongest marine forts. It holds a special place in history as one of the two forts where Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj personally hoisted the saffron flag, the other being Torna.

For those interested in Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's early life, Shivneri Fort, situated 105 kilometres from Pune, is a significant landmark. Sinhagad Fort, also known as the 'Lion Fort', is perched approximately 30 kilometres from Pune, standing tall at 1,316 metres above sea level. It was named in honour of Tanaji Malusare, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's valiant Army General. Pratapgad Fort in Satara District carries the legacy of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, famously associated with the historic episode involving Afzal Khan. The fort's double line of fortifications and walls of varying heights tell tales of its historical significance. Lastly, Lohagad Fort, known as the 'Iron Fort', has a rich history spanning multiple dynasties, from the Satavahanas to the Marathas. Its well-preserved gates offer a glimpse into Maharashtra's past, while providing breathtaking views of the Karla and Bhaja Caves.

These forts not only offer a window into Maharashtra's glorious history but also present captivating opportunities for exploration and adventure within their ancient walls.

WILDLIFE

Maharashtra's wildlife is a symphony of nature's finest, led by the Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve, the state's largest and oldest sanctuary. This 'Jewel of Vidarbha' conceals a thriving ecosystem, including an impressive tiger population. Other elusive creatures like panthers, sloth bears, and bison also call it home.

Venture to the Nagzira Wildlife Sanctuary to immerse yourself in pristine wilderness. Tigers, panthers, and a vibrant array of wildlife coexist in this haven, accompanied by the delightful flutter of countless butterflies. The Melghat Tiger Reserve, nestled in Amravati district, is a dedicated protector of tigers across its sprawling 1,676 sq. km. expanse. For bird enthusiasts, the Karnala Bird Sanctuary, in Raigad District, is an avian paradise. A trek to Karnala fort, nestled within the sanctuary, is a popular adventure. The Bor Wildlife Sanctuary in Wardha District shelters over 200 animal species, including tigers, panthers, and a myriad of other creatures.

In the Gondia District, the Navegaon National Park offers breathtaking forest vistas from its watchtower. The Dr. Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary within hosts 60 percent of Maharashtra's bird species and an array of ornamental, medical, and aromatic plants. Nature lovers should not miss the Bhimashankar Wildlife Sanctuary in Pune District. It is not only home to the Bhimashankar Temple, one of Maharashtra's five Jyotirlingas, but also a variety of wildlife, including leopards, barking deer, and Malabar grey hornbills.

WINE TOURISM

Maharashtra has been famous for its wine industry and Nashik is popularly known as the Wine Capital of India. Blessed with a favourable climate, Maharashtra is one of the largest wine-producing regions in the country. The most popular vineyards in are found in the Deccan Plateau region and around Nashik, Baramati, Pune, Solapur and Sangli. Nashik, in particular, with an ideal climate for grape cultivation ensures the grapes retain their acidity and develop a distinct flavour. There are around 30 vineyards operating in the area. Wine tourism is becoming increasingly popular as is evident by the growing number of wineries that organise tasting sessions and festivals. Today there are many tour operators/vineyards that conduct wine tours; ranging from wine tasting, grape stomping activities, personalised wine tours, luxury stays, etc.

Maharashtra is a land of myriad tourist attractions and unforgettable experiences. From the pulsating energy of Mumbai to the tranquil serenity of its hill stations, from the historical legacies etched in its forts to the mesmerizing wilderness of its national parks, Maharashtra leaves an indelible mark on every traveller's heart. Whether you seek the embrace of nature or the cultural richness of its cities, Maharashtra offers has something for everyone. So, pack your bags, embark on this enchanting journey, and let Maharashtra captivate your senses.



WINE CAPITAL OF INDIA